

5. Since October 2011 there has been a minimum charge of 5p for carrier bags in Wales.

- (a) (i) Explain in terms of our natural resources why we should reduce our use of plastic carrier bags. [2]

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- (ii) Describe **three** benefits to the environment if fewer plastic bags are used. [3]

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- (b) Before the introduction of charges, 350 million plastic bags were used every year. Five years later this figure had dropped to 70 million used every year. Before a charge was introduced in England, 7 500 million plastic carrier bags were used per year. If the same success is achieved as in Wales, calculate the number of plastic carrier bags that will be in use per year in England five years later. [3]

number =

- (c) When researchers collected reused plastic bags from supermarket shoppers they found large numbers of bacteria in almost all carrier bags. Explain why this is a concern. [2]

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